

Understanding Rural Lifestyle

Golpura Village, Dhar District

Group 4: Varun Muddada, Anshika Tripathi, Aditi Sharma, Sarthak Balodi, Shaurya Purwar, Harsh Gupta, Vimanshu Chandra, Maulik Singhal



DHAN Foundation





Village Profile: Golpura

Location & Demographics

- Panchayat: Temarni, District: Dhar
- Total Population: 721 (367 males, 354 females, 69 children)
- Households: 123
- Category: Scheduled Tribe

Community Identity

- Religion: Hindu
- Surnames: Maurya, Jarman, Eske, Nargis
- Languages: Nimandi, Hindi

Infrastructure & Livelihood

- Housing: Kutcha and semi-finished houses
- Water: Wells, taps, tanks
- Occupation: Agriculture, livestock farming
- Major Crops: Maize, cotton, soybean

Study Objectives

Cultural Understanding

Understand the lifestyle and culture of the village community.

Challenge Identification

Find problems and challenges faced by villagers and their possible solutions.

PRA Techniques

Utilize key PRA techniques to capture a holistic understanding of the local context.





Cultural Celebrations

1

February: Chauthi

Traditional festival celebrated in early spring.

2

July: Jirothi

Celebrated as they begin planting maize crop.

3

Year-Round

Other festivals include Holi, Raksha Bandhan, and more.

Government Schemes

Key welfare programs supporting the village community:

1

PM Awas Yojana

Housing support for eligible families.



2

Har Ghar Jal Yojana

Ensuring tap water connection to every household.



3

Vridh Yojana

Pension scheme for elderly citizens.





PRA TOOLS



Transect Walk Observations



Village Road



Washroom



Water Sources



Temple



Irrigation System

Social And Resource Map



HISTORICAL TIMELINE

GOLPURA

- 1965 Hanuman Mandir & Bhilek Dev Mandir Establishment
- First Handpump 1974
- 1975 Anganwadi started
- First Motorcycle 1985
- 1993 Talab
- Shop / First Tractor 1995
- 2000 Electricity Came to the village
- First Permanent dwelling 2003
- 2007 1st keypad phone was bought by individual in the village
- Toilet / Bathroom build under PM Sauchalya Yojna 2014
- 2015 Dambar road Constructed {Main Road}
- ULTRATECH FACTORY 2017 STARTED
- 2022 Water Tank Construction started & Completed
- 2025 MANGLIK SHAWAN {Under Construction}

1

Developmental Lag

- ❑ Electricity arrived in 2000 and the first permanent dwelling in 2003, decades after the temple establishment in 1965.
- ❑ Inference: Basic infrastructure historically lagged behind social and religious structures.

2

Recent Government Push

- ❑ Key infrastructure (toilets 2014, Dambar Road 2015, water tank 2022) is all post-2014.
- ❑ Inference: Development in the last decade is heavily driven by external government schemes and industrial proximity.

3

Modernisation Paced

- ❑ Technology adoption was slow—first handpump (1974), first motorcycle (1985), first tractor (1995), first keypad phone (2007).
- ❑ Inference: Technology adoption is incremental, following economic capability.

Mobility Map

1

High Transactional Costs

Essential formal institutions like the bank, police station and post office are all located away from the village.

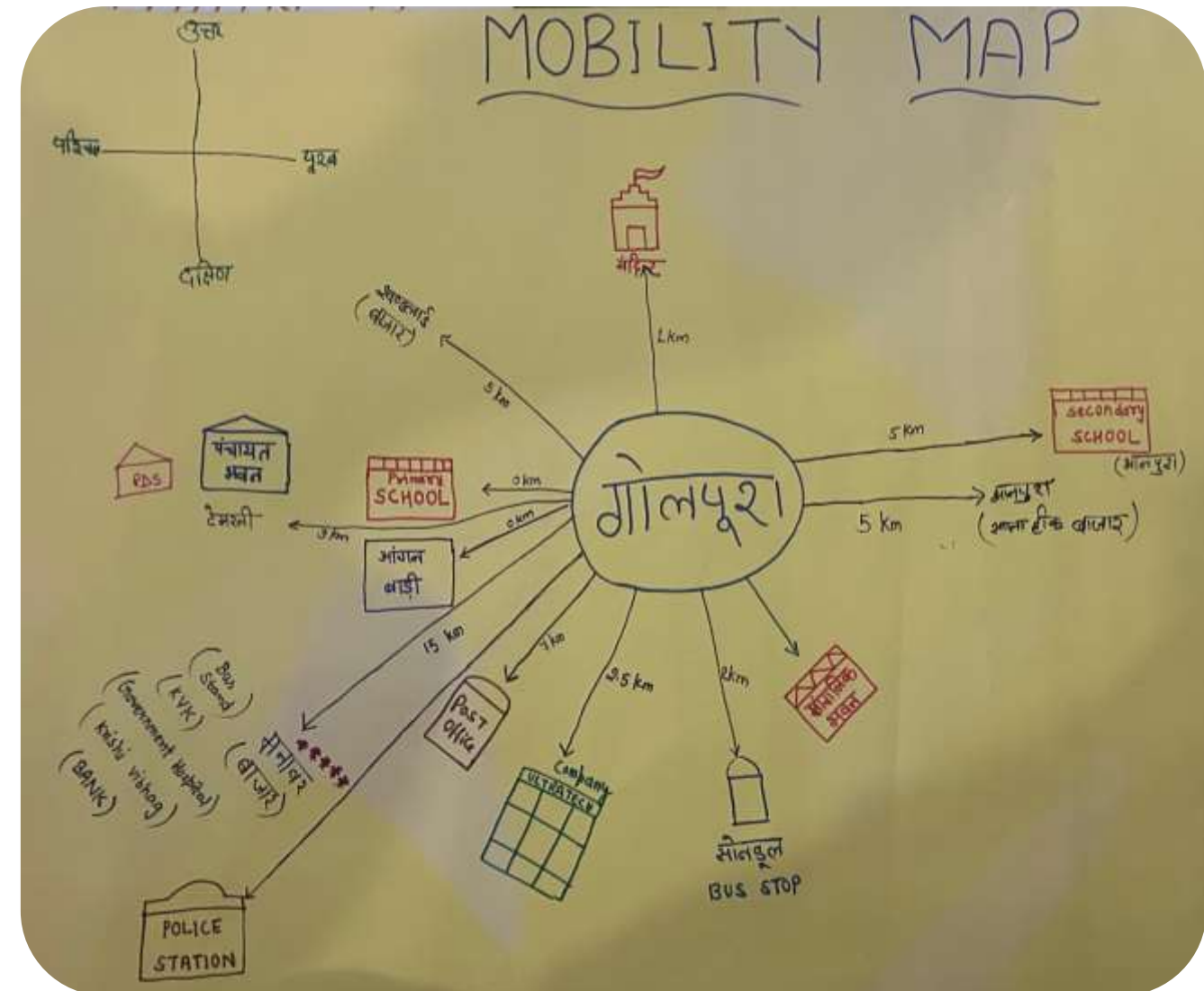
The long distance creates high barriers to accessing formal credit, justice, and social security, pushing the community towards informal systems.

2

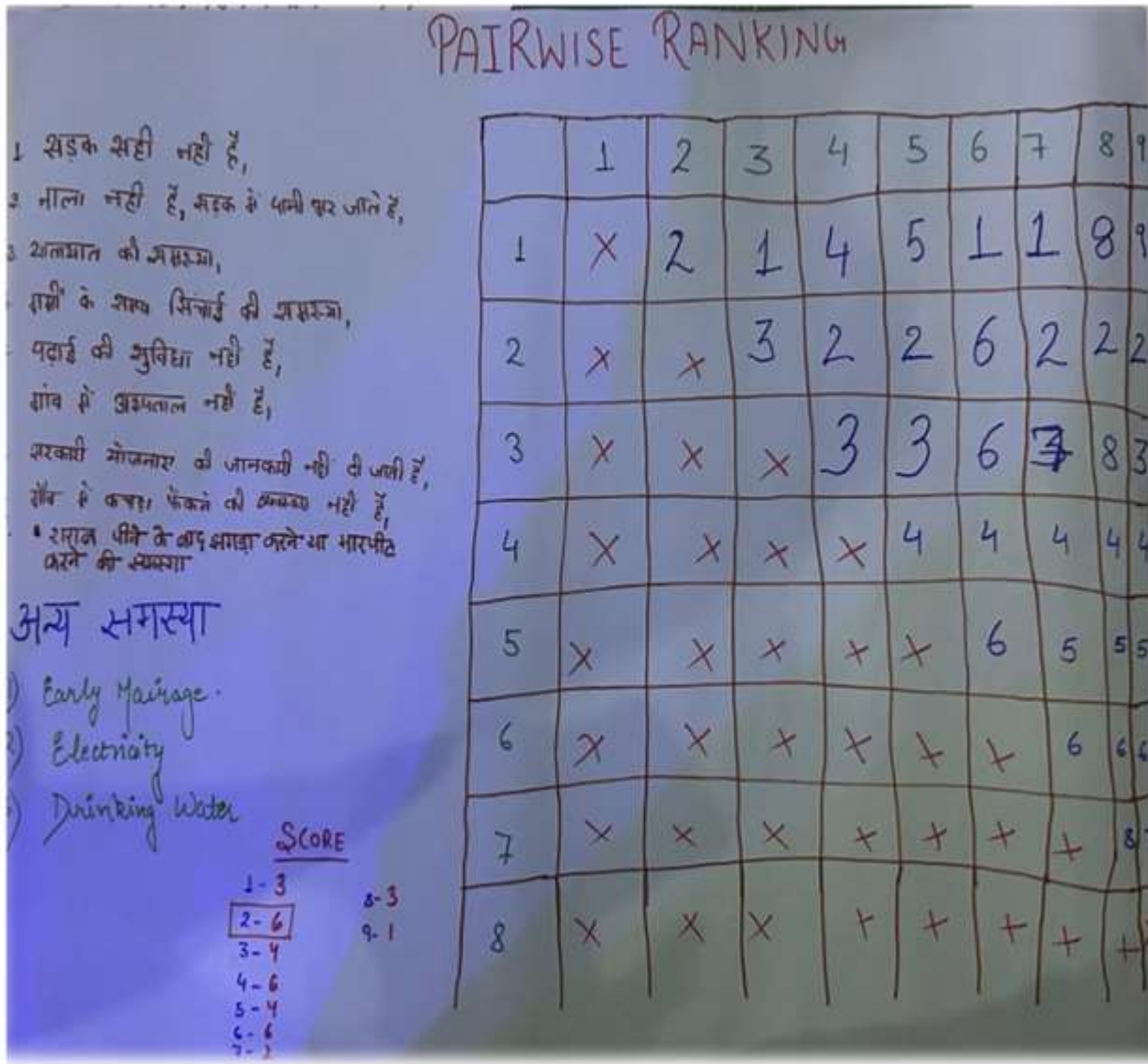
Education Drop-off Point

The primary school is local, but the secondary school is located away from the village.

This distance likely contributes to higher dropout rates at the transition to secondary education, particularly for girls.



Community Problem Prioritization (Pairwise Ranking)



Key Findings

- 1 Top Priority: Drainage Facilities**
Highest-ranked issue with modal value of 6, followed by lack of knowledge of government schemes. The highest-ranked issue is the lack of Drainage Facilities (having a modal value of 6), followed by the lack of knowledge of government schemes
- 2 Infrastructure > Social Issues**
Basic physical infrastructure viewed as most immediate threat to quality of life, prioritized over social concerns like early marriage or employment.
- 3 Inference**
The community views basic physical infrastructure as the most immediate and urgent threat to their quality of life.

Problem Analysis from Golpura Village

Samasyā Vrkṣ – Problem and Solution Tree

Core Issues

Water scarcity and poor hygiene create a cycle of poor health and low productivity.

Root Causes

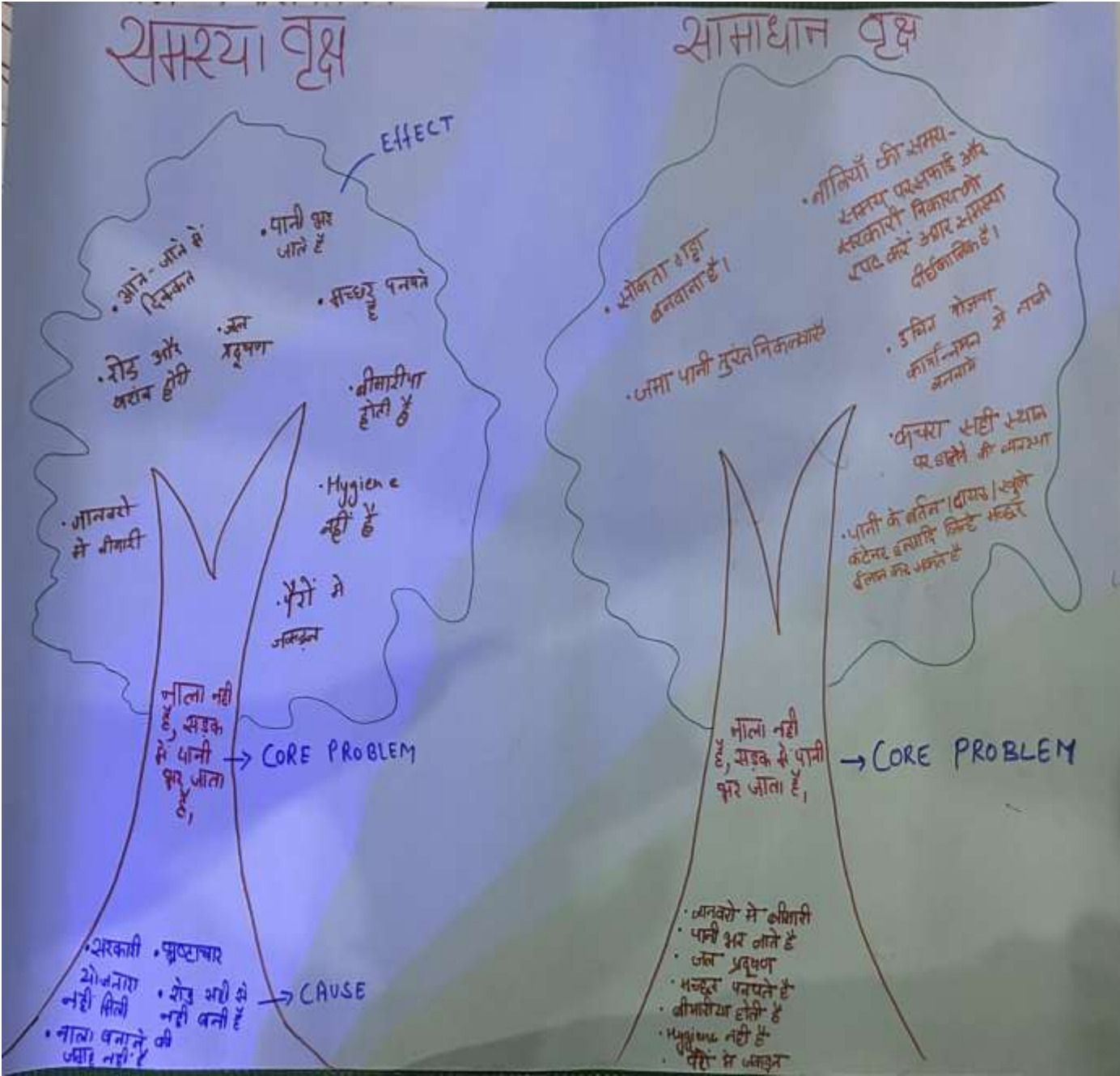
Lack of awareness, weak infrastructure, and dependence on limited water sources.

Broader Impact

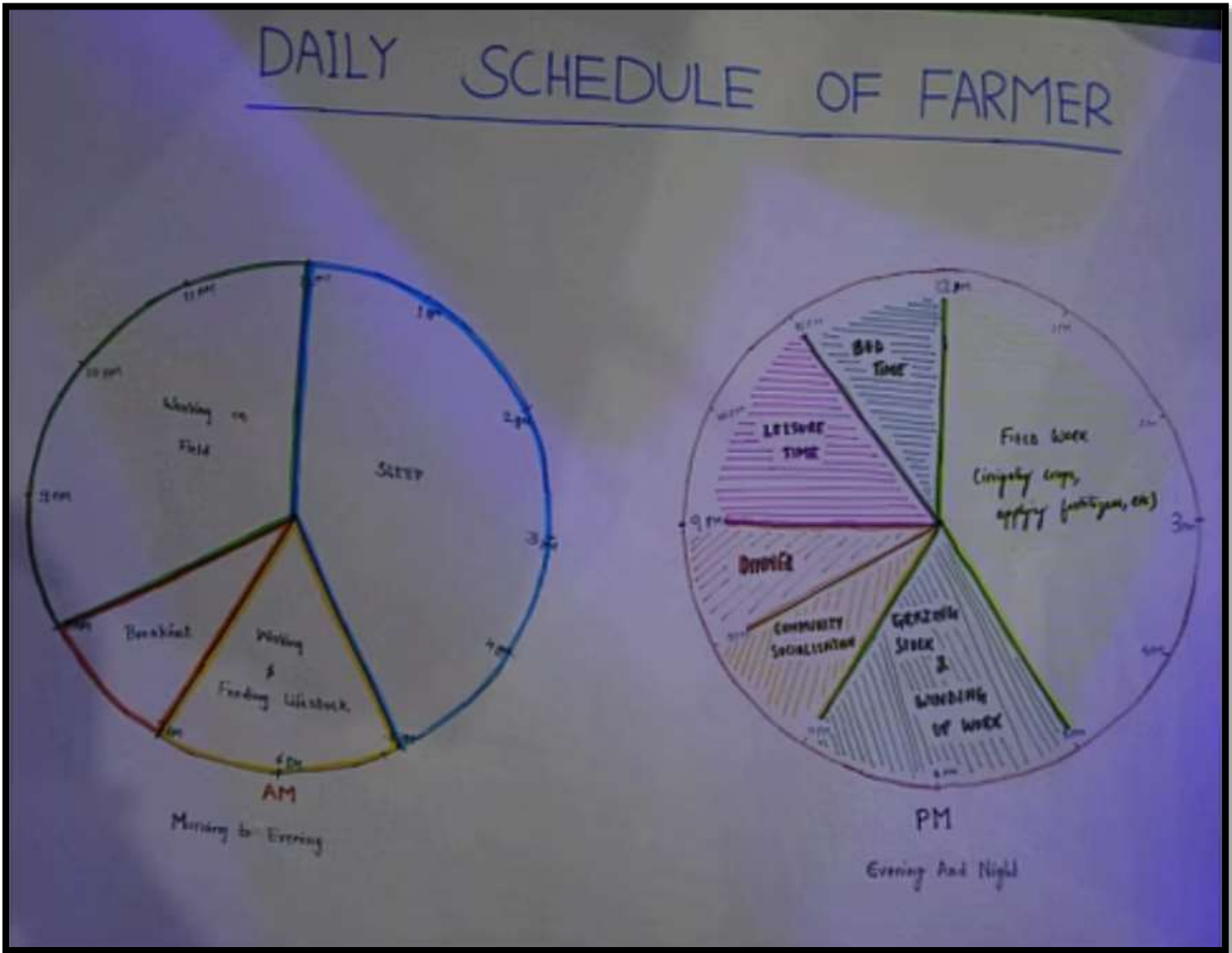
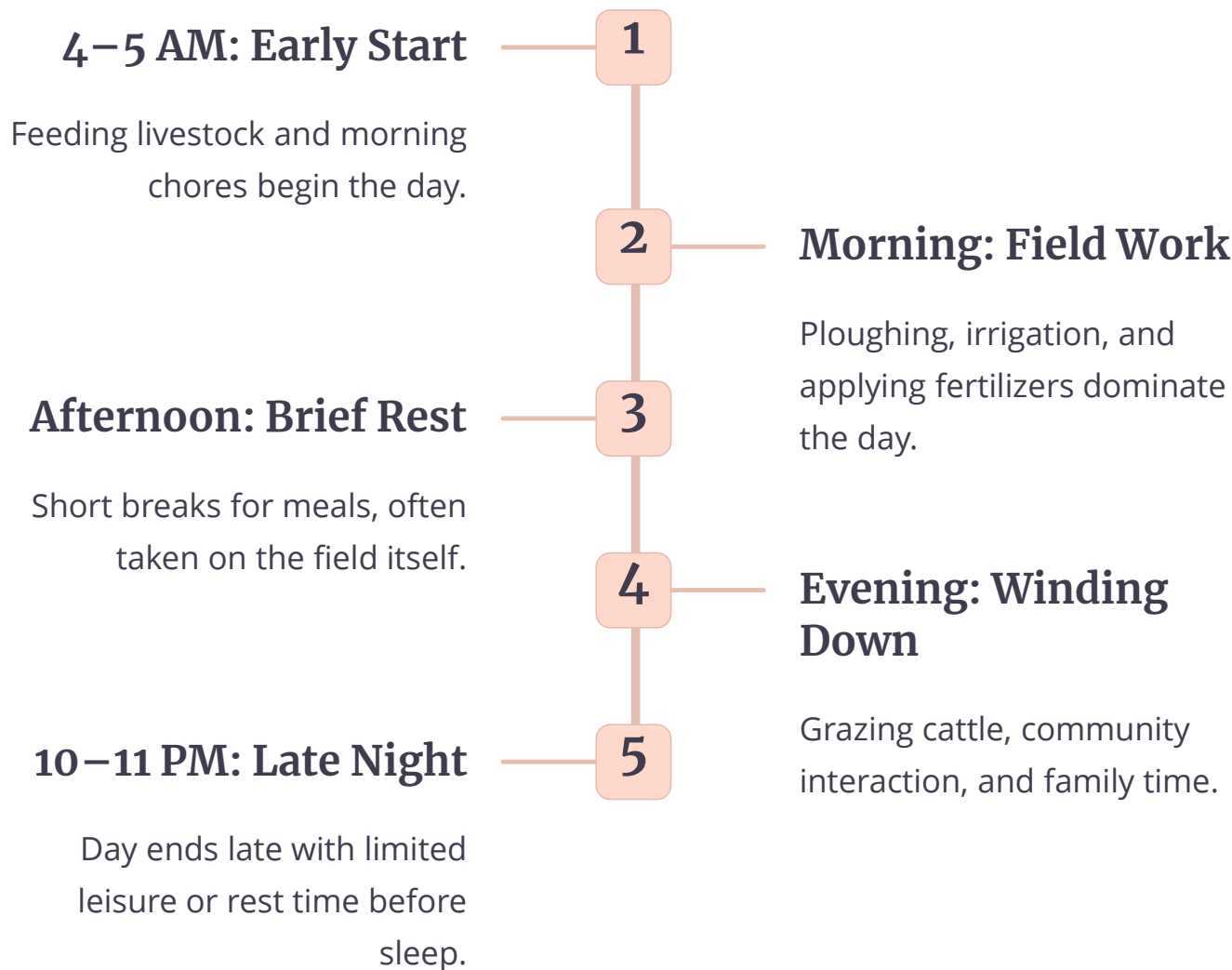
Affects education, livelihoods, and increases women's daily workload significantly.

Path Forward

Community awareness, sanitation facilities, and sustainable water management are key solutions.



Daily Schedule of Farmer



The schedule reflects a physically demanding lifestyle, driven by seasonal work and natural daylight cycles.

CASH FLOW

For Farmers

1. Cash Flow of Cotton Farmers

- Tracks money inflows and outflows during the cotton cultivation cycle
- Helps assess profitability and financial stability of farmers
- Strongly influenced by seasonal and market factors

2. Cash Inflows

- Sales revenue from cotton produce
- Government schemes – PM-KISAN, PMFBY (Crop Insurance), Subsidies
- Loans & credit from banks or SHGs
- Sale of by-products like cottonseed, husk, and fibre waste

3. Cash Outflows

- Purchase of seeds, fertilizers, and pesticides
- Labour wages and farm operations costs
- Irrigation & machinery expenses
- Transport & market fees
- Loan repayments and household consumption

4. Seasonal Cash Flow Pattern

- June–July: Heavy expenses during sowing season
- Aug–Oct: Continuous investment in crop care
- Nov–Jan: Main income from cotton harvest & sales
- Feb–May: Loan repayments and reinvestment phase

5. Major Challenges

- Delayed buyer payments and mandi dues
- Rising input costs and dependence on rainfall
- Pest attacks affecting yield.

PARTICULARS	AMOUNT (₹)
SALE OF CROPS/PRODUCE (COTTON)	3,50,000
SALE OF LIVESTOCK (OCCASIONALLY)	1,10,000
SALE OF BY-PRODUCTS (MANURE, FODDER, ETC.)	15,000
LOAN (FROM “SETH”)	50,000
OTHER INCOME (CUSTOM HIRING OF TRACTOR, ETC.)	15,000
TOTAL CASH INFLOWS (A)	5,25,000

PARTICULARS	AMOUNT
PURCHASE OF SEEDS AND FERTILIZERS (COTTON)	1,80,000
PURCHASE OF PESTICIDES AND OTHER INPUTS	35,000
ANIMAL FEED AND VETERINARY EXPENSES	40,000
REPAIR & MAINTENANCE	30,000
FUEL AND ELECTRICITY	20,000
LOAN REPAYMENT (PRINCIPAL + INTEREST)	75,000
HOUSEHOLD EXPENSES	80,000
PURCHASE OF FARM EQUIPMENT (PUMP, ETC.)	60,000
TOTAL CASH OUTFLOWS (B)	5,15,000
AMOUNT (₹)	
NET CASH FLOW (A - B)	10,000

PARTICULARS	AMOUNT
OPENING CASH BALANCE	25,000
ADD: NET CASH FLOW	10,000
CLOSING CASH BALANCE	35,000

SWOT Analysis

Strengths

- Access to clean water through individual taps
- Fertile agricultural land
- Concrete houses for majority of families
- Rich cultural traditions and festivals

Weaknesses

- Poor roads, transportation, connectivity
- Lack of hospitals and medical shops
- Technological gap leading to labour shortage

Opportunities

- Rural development programs and subsidies
- Food processing, dairy, organic farming
- Solar, wind, or biogas energy initiatives

Threats

- Unstable agricultural prices
- Delays or misuse of development funds
- Droughts, floods, soil degradation
- Overuse of water resources



Challenges



Conceptual Gap

Difficulty bridging understanding when explaining PRA tools like Social Mapping and Timelines to participants.



Memory Challenges

Participants struggled to recall specific dates and years for key village events and milestones.



Awareness Gap

Widespread lack of knowledge about existing welfare schemes and government programs available to villagers.

Case Study 1: Sawan's Story

Background

Golpura is a small agrarian village relying on farming and livestock. Sawan (20) works with his father in Golpura, cultivating maize, cotton, and soybean to sustain their family in this small agrarian village.

Key Challenges

- **Water Scarcity:** No irrigation; total dependence on rainfall leads to crop failure, debt, and hunger
- **Poor Infrastructure:** Muddy roads, leaking pipes, stagnant water cause diseases and daily hardship

Impact and Resilience

- Sawan symbolizes the determination of rural youth.
- Despite hardships, he continues to work hard and hope for change.
- His perseverance contributes to food security and community survival.



Case Study 2: Village Economy

Two Small Shops – Heart of Golpura's Resilience

In Golpura (MP), two small shops from the heart of the village's economy, symbolizing resilience and self-reliance

Shop 1: Legacy & Stability

Run by a farmer inspired by family tradition. Sells essentials (₹5–₹50 items) providing steady income beyond farming.

Shop 2: Struggle & Hope

Started by a former labourer after years of hardship. Works on credit and trust, limited by poor electricity and low margins. A small refrigerator for ice creams marks his quiet progress.

Both shops reflect the spirit of rural India — where hard work, hope, and community keep the economy alive.



Case Study 3: Kalli Bai's Journey



Background

Kalli Bai, an uneducated tribal woman from Golpura, lives with her husband and three children in a PM Awas Yojana house — her only sign of dignity in a life of hardship.



Economic

Unstable income, dependence on moneylenders (3% interest/month), no awareness of government schemes



Social

Early marriage at 17, dowry burden, domestic violence due to husband's alcoholism



Cultural

Taboos during menstruation; forced to work even when unwell



Gender Inequality

No voice in family decisions; daughter's schooling often neglected

Resilience & Hope

Joined a Self-Help Group (SHG) learning about women's rights, savings, and welfare schemes. Dreams of opening a Jan Dhan account and applying for PM Kisan Samman Nidhi.

Case Study



Background

- Golpura (Manawar, MP) — a Nimad tribal village showing steady progress in education and governance.
- Insights from a local Anganwadi teacher highlight key aspects of learning and community life.

Key Highlights

- Anganwadi: 59 children enrolled, ~25 attend daily; provides free meals (kheer-puri on Tuesdays) and learning material.
- Education: Parents encourage schooling for both boys and girls; youth move to cities for higher studies in medicine & engineering.
- Panchayat: Active monthly meetings; women participate and are heard.
- Social Norms: Legal marriage age followed; non-veg diet common outside Anganwadi meals.

Conclusion

- The Anganwadi is a foundation of growth for Golpura's children.
- Strong governance and rising aspirations reflect a village blending tradition with progress.

Key Learnings from Rural Immersion

ASK Framework – Golpura Village



Attitude: Mindset Changes

- Developed empathy and respect for rural communities and their resilience
- Learned humility and inclusiveness from villagers' warmth and cooperation.
- Realized the importance of collective effort and ethical leadership in addressing inequality.



Skill: Practical Abilities

- Enhanced communication and interpersonal skills
- Learned PRA/PALM tools: social, resource, and mobility mapping.
- Strengthened analytical, observation, and problem-solving abilities
- Developed teamwork and problem-solving abilities during simulation games and collective field exercises.



Knowledge: Contextual Learning

- Gained insights into rural livelihoods, agriculture, local governance.
- Understood Nimad tribal culture and community decision-making.
- Learned about SHGs, JLGs, government schemes and implementation challenges.

Way Forward

Potential Solutions

- ✓ Encourage skill training programs for youth and women
- ✓ Promote technological adoption using demonstrations
- ✓ Organize workshops on rural credit programs and bank loans vs. moneylenders
- ✓ Support microfinance, SHGs, and farmer cooperatives
- ✓ Strengthen rural roads, irrigation, and electrification
- ✓ Expand rural schools with trained teachers and e-learning tools
- ✓ Improve primary healthcare and medicine services
- ✓ Organize awareness camps on hygiene and nutrition
- ✓ Facilitate crop insurance and better market linkages



Strategic Direction

- Strengthen collaboration among government, NGOs, and local communities
- Empower rural youth as change agents
- Focus on inclusive and sustainable rural growth
- Promote rural tourism opportunities





Thank You For Watching